INVESTMENTS · SENIOR ANALYST TO PORTFOLIO MANAGER · CAPITAL ALLOCATION

Equity Universe Capital Allocation and Preferred Entry Ranges

All 47 individual equities in the research universe — the 32 held in retirement-portfolio-66 plus 15 researched or newly added names, including CAT and PLTR — ranked for the marginal dollar after a week in which three of four hyperscalers turned free-cash-flow negative and the semiconductor complex fell ~7% in a day.

HOLDINGS BASIS	PRICES	MANDATE	HORIZON
retirement-portfolio-66.xlsx	**Official close, Fri. Oct 30, 2026**	**Total return · $80K pension floor**	**~10 years · 10%/yr hurdle**

Executive decision

Friday's sell-off put four quality names inside their entry bands at the same time — GE Vernova, TSMC, ASML and Microsoft — for the first time in this report series. I recommend taking one tranche in each (~$8,300) and sending the remaining ~$34,700 of cash to VXUS and AVUV. That is a change from the Oct 20 recommendation, which sent all cash to the diversifiers. The reason is practical: the diversifier gap has now gone unfunded for five consecutive workbooks while single-name buying continued, and a rule that keeps being skipped protects less than a modified one that gets executed. Everything outside these four names should wait. Most of the universe is gated by weight, by an open print, or by a write-up that does not yet exist.

PORTFOLIO VALUE	OCT 30 MOVE	DEPLOYABLE CASH	DIVERSIFIER GAP	AI CLUSTER
$1.723M	**−$17.1K**	**$43,000**	**$182.6K**	**22.7%**
v66 qty × Oct 30 close; funds at v66 NAV	−0.99% vs. S&P −1.8%, Nasdaq −2.8%	Unchanged line since v59 — please confirm	VXUS 2.55% vs 10%; AVUV 1.85% vs 5%	Semis 5.70%, hyperscalers 14.9%, power 2.1%

The week's real news: the self-funding test failed for three of four hyperscalers. The Oct 18 review drew the line between AI *self-funders* and AI *borrowers*. This week Alphabet reported negative free cash flow (−$9.1B) with long-term debt at $125B and 2027 capex guided above $300B; Amazon's trailing free cash flow went to −$42.4B with 2027 capex "meaningfully more"; and Meta posted its first quarterly cash outflow in over a decade. Microsoft was the exception (FCF $18.6B, capex below fears). Two conclusions follow. First, supplier revenue visibility for 2027 *improved* — TSM, ASML and GEV are being paid to build. Second, the risk moved onto hyperscaler balance sheets, which is why GOOG drops out of the add list despite being 38% below Morningstar fair value, and why META gets a half-tranche only.

Discipline notes from v66 (v63 → v66).

- **DELL initiated:** 4 sh at ~$442 against the house Oct 19 call of no initiation above $340 (starter ≤$340, add ≤$300). Now $424. Hold the 4 shares; do not average down above $340.
- **NVDA, fifth straight add:** 58 → 61 sh at ~$212. Position 0.72% vs. the ~0.5% guideline. Price is now inside the zone; size is not.
- **ADBE +4 sh at ~$248**, above the $240 gate. **ASML +1 at ~$1,667** (gate met at the time). **TSM +3 at ~$413** and **UBER +20 at ~$67** — both inside their bands. **VIS residual exited** (6 sh), which closes the open item from Oct 18.
- **VXUS (534) and AVUV (259) unchanged** for a fifth workbook (v53, v59, v61, v63, v66). The $43,000 cash line is also unchanged across that span despite net single-name buying, so please confirm it is real before executing.

Recommended deployment

Option B — One tranche at gate + diversifiers RECOMMENDED

Trade	Shares	Close	Amount	New wt.
Buy GEV	3	$857.75	$2,573	1.64%
Buy TSM	5	$406.08	$2,030	1.16%
Buy ASML	1	$1,565.44	$1,565	0.82%
Buy MSFT	4	$521.90	$2,088	3.15%
Buy VXUS	281	$82.33	$23,135	3.89%
Buy AVUV	94	$123.43	$11,602	2.53%
Total from cash			**$42,993**	

Direct semis 5.70% → 5.91% (inside ~6%). AI cluster 22.7% → 23.2%. Diversifiers 4.4% → 6.4%; gap falls to ~$147.8K.

Option A — Framework first (Oct 20 recommendation)

All cash to VXUS 348 sh ($28,651) and AVUV 116 sh ($14,317). No single names.

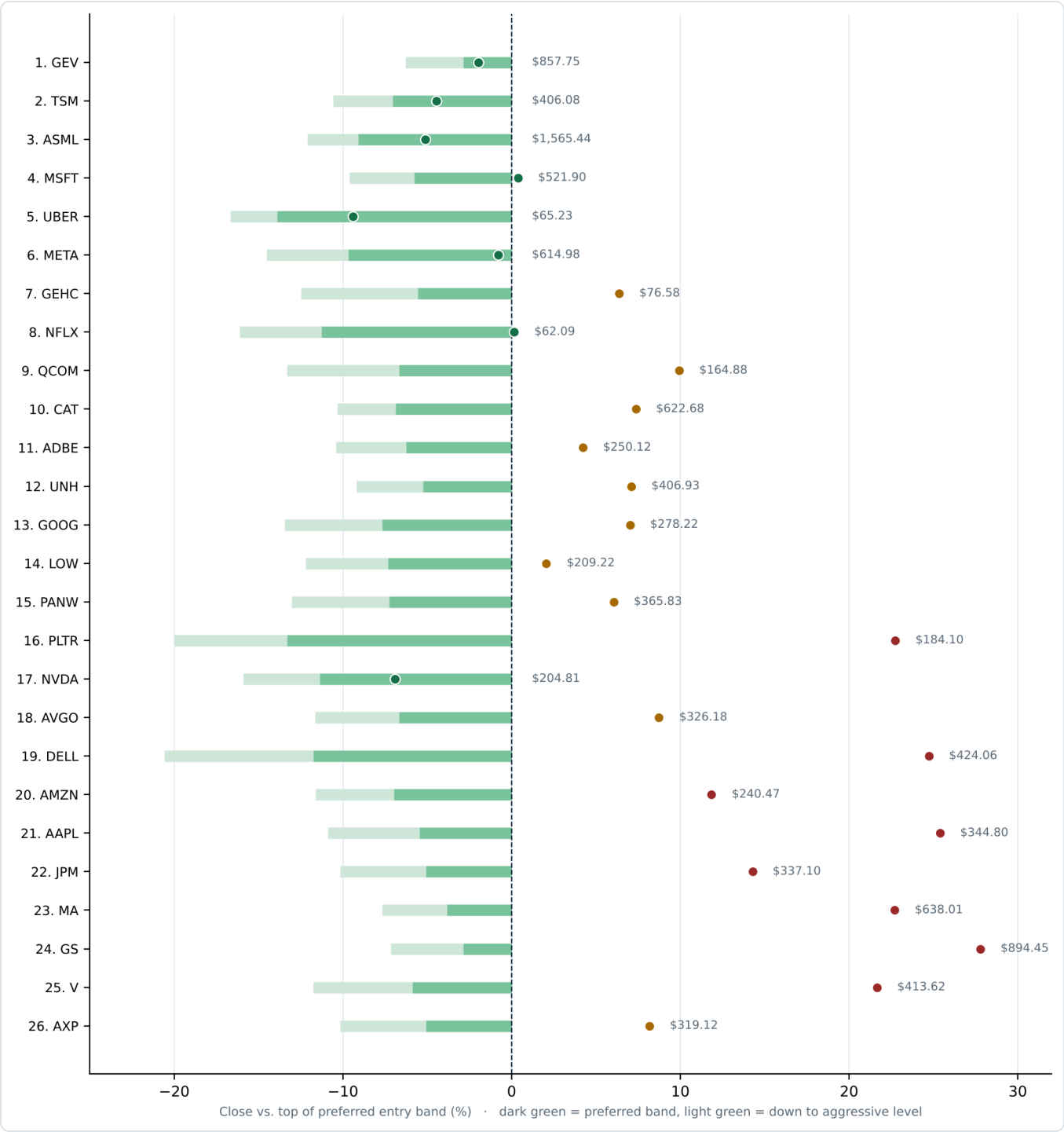
- Diversifiers 4.4% → 6.9%; gap ~$139.6K.
- No added AI-cluster risk.
- Cost: forgoes the cleanest four-name gate alignment since this series began, after a ~7% one-day semis drop.

If you prefer A, I would not argue hard against it. What I would argue against is a sixth workbook in which neither happens.

Tranche C — the next funding step, unchanged. TLXIX is 9.47% of the book, over the 8% hard ceiling. Trimming to 8% frees ~$25,285 (~634 sh), split 2/3 VXUS / 1/3 AVUV. In a taxable account that realizes ~$15,900 of long-term gain (v66 average cost $14.84/sh). Account location of TLXIX, CRM and VTWO is still the open item gating this.

What the next dollars after this should go to, in order: (1) UBER after the Nov 4 print, if the $90.61 house value holds; (2) META half-tranche (~3 sh) at ≤$620 once Q4 cash flow is visible or the price reaches ≤$560; (3) GEHC at ≤$72 after a short re-underwrite; (4) NFLX at ≤$62 only after a house write-up exists.

Gate map — where each name sits against its entry band



Dots left of the dashed line are at or inside their preferred band. Tiers A–C only; income, low-fit and avoid names are in the full table. NVDA sits in its band but is blocked on size.

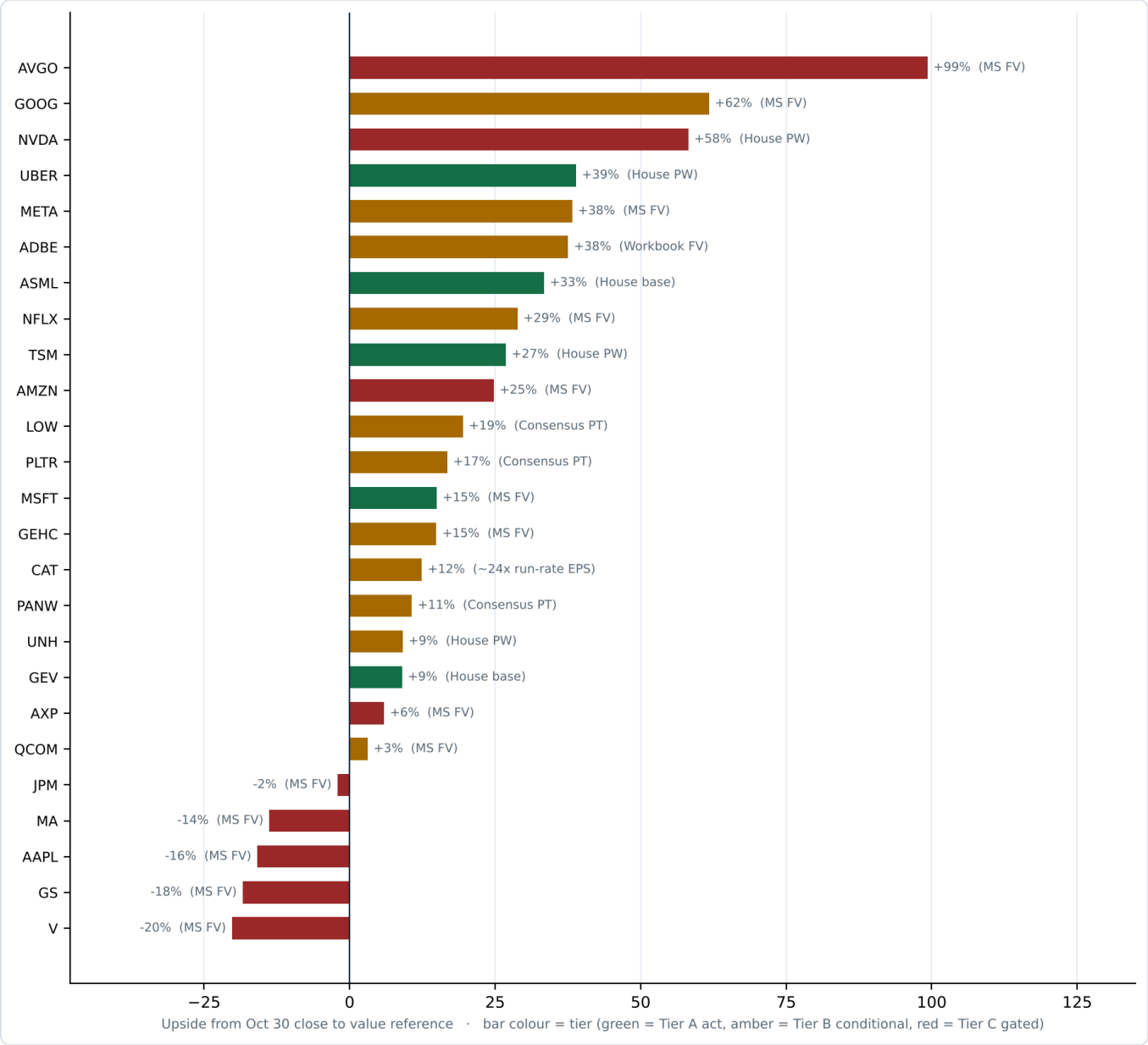
Full universe — ranked, with preferred entry ranges

Preferred entry = the band where the marginal dollar clears the 10%/yr hurdle against the value reference with an adequate margin of safety; one tranche per visit. Aggressive = add a second tranche at or below this level. No-add above = stop adding above this price. **House** values come from underwritten house research; **MS FV** is the Morningstar fair value carried in v66; values marked **provisional** are not house-underwritten (consensus target or a multiple on run-rate earnings) and need a write-up before any money moves.

#	Ticker	Close	Day	Weight	Value ref.	Upside	Preferred entry	Aggressive	No-add above	Status	Next catalyst
Tier A — At the gate: act with incremental capital											
1	**GEV** GE Vernova	$857.75	-3.4%	1.49%	$935 House base (Sep 18)	+9%	**$850–875**	≤ $820	> $975	In band	Reported Oct 28
2	**TSM** TSMC ADR	$406.08	-6.0%	1.04%	$515 House PW (Oct 15)	+27%	**$395–425**	≤ $380	> $435	In band	Nov 10 monthly sales
3	**ASML** ASML ADR	$1,565.44	-6.6%	0.73%	$2,088 House base (Oct 14)	+33%	**$1,500–1,650**	≤ $1,450	> $1,800	In band	CMD Jun 10, 2027
4	**MSFT** Microsoft	$521.90	-1.6%	3.03%	$600 MS FV (v66)	+15%	**$490–520**	≤ $470	> $580	At band top	Reported Oct 28
5	**UBER** Uber	$65.23	-0.8%	0.37%	$90.61 House PW (Sep 25)	+39%	**$62–72**	≤ $60	> $82	In band · Wait for print	Q3 Nov 4 (am)
Tier B — Conditional: a price, print or write-up gate still open											
6	**META** Meta Platforms	$614.98	-1.5%	2.25%	$850 MS FV (v66)	+38%	**$560–620**	≤ $530	> $700	In band · Half-tranche	Reported Oct 21
7	**GEHC** GE HealthCare	$76.58	+0.2%	0.23%	$88.00 MS FV (v66)	+15%	**$68–72**	≤ $63	> $80	+6% above band · Re-underwrite	Q4 early Feb
8	**NFLX** Netflix	$62.09	+0.1%	1.80%	$80.00 MS FV (v66)	+29%	**$55–62**	≤ $52	> $70	At band top · Write-up gate	Q4 mid-Jan
9	**QCOM** Qualcomm	$164.88	-11.1%	1.00%	$170 MS FV (v66)	+3%	**$140–150**	≤ $130	> $170	+10% above band · Approaching	FQ4 Nov 4 (pm)
10	**CAT** Caterpillar	$622.68	-3.8%	Not held	$700 ~24x run-rate EPS (provisional)	+12%	**$540–580**	≤ $520	> $640	+7% above band · Write-up gate	Reported Oct 29
11	**ADBE** Adobe	$250.12	+0.8%	0.57%	$344 Workbook FV (v66)	+38%	**$225–240**	≤ $215	> $290	+4% above band · Above gate	FQ4 mid-Dec
12	**UNH** UnitedHealth	$406.93	-1.0%	1.19%	$444 House PW (Oct 13)	+9%	**$360–380**	≤ $345	> $430	+7% above band · Above gate	Q4 mid-Jan
13	**GOOG** Alphabet C	$278.22	-1.5%	2.34%	$450 MS FV (v66)	+62%	**$240–260**	≤ $225	> $340	+7% above band · Condition failed	Q4 early Feb
14	**LOW** Lowe's	$209.22	+0.9%	Not held	$250 Consensus PT (provisional)	+19%	**$190–205**	≤ $180	> $230	+2% above band	Q3 Nov 18 (am)
15	**PANW** Palo Alto Networks	$365.83	-3.9%	Not held	$405 Consensus PT (provisional)	+11%	**$320–345**	≤ $300	> $385	+6% above band	FQ1 Nov 18 (pm)
16	**PLTR** Palantir	$184.10	-6.3%	Not held	$215 Consensus PT (provisional)	+17%	**$130–150**	≤ $120	> $175	+23% above band · Write-up + print	Q3 Nov 2 (pm)
Tier C — Gated by weight, size or prior discipline											
17	**NVDA** NVIDIA	$204.81	-4.1%	0.72%	$324 House PW (Aug 28)	+58%	**$195–220**	≤ $185	> $240	In band · Size-blocked	Q3 FY27 Nov 17 (pm)
18	**AVGO** Broadcom	$326.18	-5.5%	2.21%	$650 MS FV (v66)	+99%	**$280–300**	≤ $265	—	+9% above band · Weight-gated	FQ4 mid-Dec
19	**DELL** Dell Technologies	$424.06	-10.8%	0.10%	—	—	**$300–340**	≤ $270	> $340	+25% above band · Above starter gate	FQ3 late Nov
20	**AMZN** Amazon	$240.47	-1.4%	7.26%	$300 MS FV (v66)	+25%	**$200–215**	≤ $190	—	+12% above band · Weight-gated	Q4 early Feb
21	**AAPL** Apple	$344.80	-1.2%	6.80%	$290 MS FV (v66)	-16%	**$260–275**	≤ $245	—	+25% above band · Weight-gated	FQ4 Nov 2 (pm)
22	**JPM** JPMorgan	$337.10	-1.9%	7.00%	$330 MS FV (v66)	-2%	**$280–295**	≤ $265	—	+14% above band · Sleeve full	Q4 mid-Jan
23	**MA** Mastercard	$638.01	+0.4%	6.41%	$550 MS FV (v66)	-14%	**$500–520**	≤ $480	—	+23% above band · Sleeve full	Q4 late Jan
24	**GS** Goldman Sachs	$894.45	-3.6%	5.45%	$730 MS FV (v66)	-18%	**$680–700**	≤ $650	—	+28% above band · Sleeve full	Q4 mid-Jan

#	Ticker	Close	Day	Weight	Value ref.	Upside	Preferred entry	Aggressive	No-add above	Status	Next catalyst
25	**V** Visa	$413.62	+0.8%	2.40%	$330 MS FV (v66)	-20%	**$320–340**	≤ $300	—	+22% above band · Sleeve full	FQ1 late Jan
26	**AXP** American Express	$319.12	-1.4%	1.85%	$338 MS FV (v66)	+6%	**$280–295**	≤ $265	—	+8% above band · Sleeve full	Q4 late Jan
Tier D — Hold, no new money (income, uncovered or sleeve full)											
27	**CRM** Salesforce	$229.10	-0.8%	1.32%	$270 MS FV (v66)	+18%	**—**	—	—	Funding source	FQ3 early Dec
28	**PEP** PepsiCo	$137.41	+2.7%	1.32%	$169 MS FV (v66)	+23%	**$120–125**	≤ $115	—	+10% above band · Income	Q4 Feb
29	**AMT** American Tower	$187.85	+1.1%	2.53%	$225 MS FV (v66)	+20%	**$170–178**	≤ $160	—	+6% above band · Income	Q4 Feb
30	**DIS** Disney	$110.96	+0.0%	1.26%	$125 MS FV (v66)	+13%	**$95–100**	≤ $90	—	+11% above band · Uncovered	FQ4 Nov 17 (am)
31	**XOM** ExxonMobil	$187.25	+2.2%	4.12%	$162 MS FV (v66)	-13%	**$145–155**	≤ $135	—	+21% above band · Income	Reported Oct 30
32	**KO** Coca-Cola	$94.12	+1.4%	1.62%	$80.00 MS FV (v66)	-15%	**$70–75**	≤ $66	—	+25% above band · Income	Q4 Feb
33	**PM** Philip Morris	$208.80	+0.1%	2.21%	$190 MS FV (v66)	-9%	**$165–175**	≤ $155	—	+19% above band · Income	Q4 Feb
34	**SO** Southern Co	$93.70	+0.8%	2.07%	$83.00 MS FV (v66)	-11%	**$75–78**	≤ $72	—	+20% above band · Income	Q3 Nov 5 (am)
35	**BMY** Bristol-Myers	$62.47	+1.8%	1.16%	$70.00 MS FV (v66)	+12%	**—**	—	—	Uncovered	Q4 early Feb
36	**BATRA** Atlanta Braves A	$54.78	+0.3%	0.08%	$53.77 MS FV (v66)	-2%	**—**	—	—	Immaterial	Q3 Nov 4
37	**LMT** Lockheed Martin	$637.06	-1.0%	Not held	$654 Consensus PT (provisional)	+3%	**$540–580**	≤ $520	> $640	+10% above band	Q4 late Jan
38	**VRTX** Vertex	$559.05	+3.5%	Not held	$576 Consensus PT (provisional)	+3%	**$470–500**	≤ $450	> $540	+12% above band	Q3 Nov 2 (pm)
Tier E — Researched, not held: low mandate fit or avoid											
39	**JNJ** Johnson & Johnson	$273.18	-0.7%	Not held	$283 Consensus PT (provisional)	+4%	**$235–250**	≤ $225	> $265	+9% above band · Low mandate fit	Q4 Jan
40	**CVS** CVS Health	$90.24	-0.1%	Not held	$114 Consensus PT (provisional)	+26%	**$78–82**	≤ $72	> $90	+10% above band · Low mandate fit	Q3 Nov 4 (am)
41	**HD** Home Depot	$329.25	+0.1%	Not held	$377 Consensus PT (provisional)	+15%	**$295–310**	≤ $280	—	+6% above band · Prefer LOW	Q3 Nov 17 (am)
42	**PG** Procter & Gamble	$161.55	+0.6%	Not held	$174 Consensus PT (provisional)	+8%	**$140–148**	≤ $135	—	+9% above band · Low mandate fit	FQ2 Jan
43	**CVX** Chevron	$235.59	+1.8%	Not held	$233 Consensus PT (provisional)	-1%	**$195–205**	≤ $185	—	+15% above band · Low mandate fit	Reported Oct 30
44	**VTR** Ventas	$84.82	+1.3%	Not held	$100 Consensus PT (provisional)	+18%	**$72–76**	≤ $68	—	+12% above band · Low mandate fit	Q4 Feb
45	**GIS** General Mills	$34.28	+2.9%	Not held	—	—	**—**	—	—	Avoid	FQ2 Dec
46	**ORCL** Oracle	$130.70	-6.3%	Not held	—	—	**—**	—	—	Avoid	FQ2 mid-Dec
47	**SPCX** SpaceX	$134.71	-6.4%	Not held	—	—	**—**	—	—	Avoid	Q4

Upside to value reference



Upside is necessary but not sufficient. AVGO, GOOG and NVDA show the most upside and are all gated: AVGO and NVDA by size, GOOG by the failed cash-flow condition. GEV shows the least upside of the Tier A names because its $935 house base predates a quarter that raised guidance; consensus is ~$1,164.

CAT and PLTR — where they stand

Neither name had house research on file. The project contains no CAT or PLTR write-up; CAT appeared only once, in the Oct 15 market commentary, as a data-center power name caught in that week's sell-off. Both are now in the universe on a **provisional** basis.

CAT — Caterpillar · $622.68 · Tier B

- **Q3 (Oct 29):** adj. EPS $7.20 (+45%), revenue $20.7B (+17%), adj. operating margin 20.6%, record backlog $78.1B. Power & Energy revenue +18%, segment profit +31%, driven partly by on-site data-center power.
- **Why it fell ~7% on the print:** ~$600M of tariff cost a quarter (~$2.2B for 2026 before recoveries), an unraised sales guide, and margins near the bottom of target. The stock is ~42% below its June high.
- **Preferred entry $540–580** (~19–20x run-rate adjusted EPS), aggressive ≤$520, no-add above $640. Starter size ~0.5%.
- **Portfolio fit:** it would join GEV and GRID in the AI-power sleeve (2.1%) — cyclical exposure on top of a secular one. A write-up should test how much of the backlog is data-center versus mining and construction.

PLTR — Palantir · $184.10 · Tier B

- **Valuation:** ~$442B market cap at ~167x trailing GAAP earnings. Down 13.5% from its Oct 12 high; reports Nov 2 after the close.
- **What is priced in (sketch):** a 10%/yr return for ten years needs ~$1.15T of value in 2036. At 30x earnings that is ~$38B of net income — several times today's level. This is a reverse-DCF sketch, not a model.
- **Preferred entry $130–150**, aggressive ≤$120, no-add above $175. At $184 it is 23% above the band. Starter cap 0.5%.
- **Portfolio fit:** AI software, so it correlates with the same capex narrative that drives a fifth of the book. The Nov 2 print and a write-up come before any decision.

Analyst notes by name

Tier A — act

GEV	Q3 strengthened the thesis: orders +96% organic, backlog $197B (+$20B q/q), FCF $5.4B, 2026 guide raised, buyback doubled to $20B. Closed $857.75, inside the $850-875 zone for the first time. One tranche; the $935 base predates this print and is conservative.
TSM	Fell 6.0% with the semis rout; now at the bottom of the band, ~27% below $515 PW. 2027 capex signals from GOOG (>$300B), AMZN and MSFT raise wafer visibility. One tranche of ~5 ADRs takes it to ~1.15% vs. the ~1.25% cap.
ASML	Down 6.6% Friday to $1,565, 25% below the $2,088 base. Gate met since Oct 14; PM added 1 sh at ~$1,667 in v66. Fund in place of NVDA, not on top of it.
MSFT	The one hyperscaler that passed the self-funding test this week: Azure +48%, capex $39.4B (below ~$50B feared), FCF $18.6B. $521.90 is at the post-print gate set Oct 18. Weight ~3.0% leaves room to ~4%.
UBER	At the $66 aggressive level, ~39% below $90.61 PW. PM added 20 sh at ~$67.45 in v66 (inside the gate). The house rule was one tranche before the print, the rest after: that tranche is done, so the next one waits for Nov 4.

Tier B — conditional

META	Below the $650 aggressive level after a 12% slide since the print. EPS ex the $9.89B settlement was ~$7.40, but Q3 was its first cash outflow in a decade. Half-tranche only; full adds need Q4 FCF back above zero.
GEHC	The margin proof arrived: adj. EBIT 16.6% vs. 14.8%, FY EPS guide raised to $4.95-5.05. That re-qualifies it, but $76.58 is above the old $75 stop-add level. Provisional band raised to $68-72 (~14x guide) pending re-underwrite.
NFLX	Price gate (<=$65) is met after the Q3 slide on a soft Q4 guide, but this 1.8% position still has no house write-up. Commission it before any add.
QCOM	Fell 11.1% Friday in the Intel/memory-led semis sell-off; now ~3% below $170 FV. Handset memory-cost squeeze is the live risk. Let the Nov 4 guide set the entry.
CAT	New to the universe. Q3 beat (adj. EPS $7.20, +45%; record $78.1B backlog; Power & Energy +18%), but shares fell on ~$2.2B of 2026 tariff cost and an unraised guide. ~42% off the June high. Provisional band ~19-20x run-rate EPS. Adds to the AI-power cluster alongside GEV and GRID.
ADBE	4% above the $240 gate. PM added 4 sh at ~$248 in v66, above the gate. No further adds until <=$240.
UNH	9% below $444 PW, 7% above the $380 gate. Hold; no chasing.
GOOG	Price is 18% below the old $340 gate, but the condition attached to it failed: first top- and bottom-line miss in ~4 years, FCF -$9.1B, long-term debt $125B, 2027 capex >$300B. Now a borrower, not a self-funder. Wait for <=$260 or Q4 FCF repair.
LOW	Not held. Preferred over HD on price (~17.5x). 2% above the top of the provisional band; rate-sensitive.
PANW	Not held. No house valuation since the Oct 8 re-rate note; band is provisional (15-20% below consensus). Trades with the AI complex. Starter only after a write-up.
PLTR	New to the universe. $442B at ~167x trailing GAAP earnings; down 13.5% from the Oct 12 high. The band needs ~30% downside to give a margin of safety at this multiple. Starter cap 0.5%; a write-up and the Nov 2 print come first.

Tier C — gated

NVDA	Price is now below the $205-220 zone, but v66 shows a fifth straight add (58 to 61 sh at ~$212). At 0.73% it is ~45% over the ~0.5% guideline. No adds until a sizing decision; strip CoreWeave marks from GAAP EPS on Nov 17.
AVGO	Valuation is not the constraint (MS FV $650, consensus $532); weight is. Largest direct semi at ~2.2%. One tranche at <=$300 only after the December print.
DELL	Initiated 4 sh at ~$442 in v66 against the house "no initiation above $340" call. Down 10.8% Friday to $424. Hold the 4 sh; do not average down above $340.
AMZN	Missed on EPS and guide; TTM FCF -$42.4B; 2027 capex "meaningfully more." AWS +39% on a $578B backlog. At ~7% weight there is no room; hold the compounder, trim review only above 8%.
AAPL	19% above MS FV at ~6.8% weight. Hold; no new money.
JPM	At ~6.8% weight; financial/payments sleeve ~22%. No new money.
MA	16% above MS FV. No new money.
GS	23% above MS FV; large embedded gain. No new money.
V	25% above MS FV. No new money.
AXP	6% below MS FV but the sleeve is full.

Tier D — hold, no new money

CRM	Funding-source candidate in the standing order; re-decide at the early-December print. No adds.
PEP	19% below MS FV, but an income name in a growth book.
AMT	17% below MS FV; rate-sensitive income name. Hold.
DIS	11% below MS FV; uncovered. <=$100 only with a write-up.
XOM	16% above MS FV with Brent ~$118 on Hormuz attacks. The book's working hedge; no adds.

KO	18% above MS FV.
PM	10% above MS FV.
SO	13% above MS FV.
BMY	Uncovered income position. No adds.
BATRA	0.08% of book. No action.
LMT	Not held. Beat and raised (FY EPS $30.35-30.75; record $292B backlog) and re-rated 20% since Oct 15. ~21x guide; no entry case at $637.
VRTX	Not held. At a 52-week high into the print; entry worsened 9% since Oct 15.

Tier E — researched, not held

JNJ	Researched, not held. 52-week high; defensive. GAAP P/E distorted by talc reserves.
CVS	Exited earlier as low conviction; nothing has changed that case.
HD	Researched alongside LOW; LOW is the cheaper way to own the same recovery.
PG	Researched, not held. Not eligible.
CVX	Duplicates XOM. Not eligible.
VTR	Sold; re-entry not consistent with the mandate.
GIS	7.3% yield on negative trailing EPS: a value trap profile. Not eligible.
ORCL	Down 51% from its high. The debt-funded OCI build-out is the "AI borrower" profile this book has avoided. Not eligible until free cash flow turns.
SPCX	House view (Oct 20) stands: ~$1.8T on ~60x revenue; would add a seventh correlated AI-capex exposure. Not eligible.

What changed this week

Date	Event	Read-through for the universe
Oct 28	FOMC holds at 3.75–4.00% (10–2; two dissents for a hike). ~85% odds of a December hike.	Rate pressure stays, but the 10-year eased to ~4.92% on Friday as stocks fell.
Oct 28	GEV: orders +96% organic, backlog $197B, FCF $5.4B, guide raised, buyback to $20B.	Thesis strengthened; price now inside the $850–875 zone.
Oct 28	GEHC: adj. EPS $1.34 vs. $1.20; adj. EBIT margin 16.6%; FY guide raised.	The margin proof the house asked for. Band raised provisionally.
Oct 28	MSFT: revenue $92.3B (+19%), Azure +48%, capex $39.4B (below ~$50B feared), FCF $18.6B.	Passes the self-funding test; at its gate.
Oct 28	GOOG: first top- and bottom-line miss in ~4 years; FCF −$9.1B; 2027 capex >$300B. Includes an $8.7B equity loss (−$0.55 EPS) — strip it, and it is still a miss.	Fails the self-funding test; add gate re-set lower and conditioned on FCF.
Oct 29	CAT: beat; record backlog; tariff drag; guide not raised; shares ~−7%.	Added to the universe provisionally.
Oct 29	AMZN: EPS and guide miss; AWS +39%; TTM FCF −$42.4B.	Weight-gated anyway; no change to posture.
Oct 30	Nasdaq −2.8%, S&P −1.8%; semis ETF (SMH) −6.9% after Intel's weak guide; VIX +32% intraday. Brent ~$118 on Hormuz attacks.	Created the gate alignment in TSM, ASML and GEV; QCOM −11%, DELL −11%, PLTR −6%.

Catalysts and what to monitor

Date	Event	Decision it informs
Nov 2 (pm)	AAPL, PLTR, VRTX	PLTR write-up; AAPL weight (6.8%) vs. the 8% ceiling.
Nov 4	UBER (am), QCOM (pm), CVS (am)	UBER second tranche; QCOM vs. the $150 gate after the memory squeeze.
Nov 5	SO (am)	Income name; no action expected.
Nov 17	NVDA (pm), DIS, HD (am)	NVDA sizing decision; strip CoreWeave marks from GAAP EPS.
Nov 18	PANW (pm), LOW (am)	Entry checks on two non-held names.
Early Dec	CRM, AVGO, ADBE prints; Dec 9 FOMC	CRM exit decision; AVGO ≤$300 tranche; a hike would pressure every staged add.

Risks and counterarguments

Against Option B

- Three of the four buys are AI-supply-chain names. If the hyperscalers' turn to debt-funded capex ends in a 2027 cut, TSM, ASML and GEV re-rate together.
- Friday may be the start of a larger drawdown, not the end of one. The bands have aggressive levels for that reason; leave room for a second tranche.
- It funds the diversifiers ~19% less than Option A.

For it

- Each name is inside a band set before this week, by house research with stated scenarios — the entries were not chosen after the fact.
- 2027 capex guidance from GOOG, AMZN and MSFT raises supplier revenue visibility even as it raises hyperscaler risk.
- It executes most of the diversifier commitment in the same order, which the last five workbooks have not.

Open items before execution: (1) confirm the $43,000 cash is real and uninvested; (2) confirm the account holding TLXIX and whether VXUS/AVUV are available there; (3) commission write-ups for NFLX, CAT and PLTR before any money goes to them; (4) a short GEHC re-underwrite to replace the provisional band; (5) a CIO decision on NVDA sizing before Nov 17.

Methodology and sources

1. **Holdings:** retirement-portfolio-66.xlsx, Export sheet (workbook modified 2026-10-29 22:39 UTC), compared with retirement-portfolio-63.xlsx; implied trade prices = Δcost ÷ Δshares. Mutual funds (TLXIX, VFFSX, FSMDX, FSSNX) held at v66 NAVs.
2. **Universe:** 32 individual equities held in v66; 13 previously researched names from the house ranking series (PANW, LOW, VRTX, LMT), earlier deep dives (JNJ, PG, CVX, GIS, CVS, HD, ORCL), the sold VTR position and the Oct 20 SPCX review; plus CAT and PLTR at the PM's request.
3. **Prices, targets, earnings dates:** Robinhood official Oct 30 closes, analyst ratings (mean price targets) and earnings calendar.
4. **House values and gates:** AI_Pullback_Gate_Review_2026-10-18, Capital_Allocation_2026-10-20, Retirement_Portfolio_Capital_Allocation_Ranking_2026-10-15, DELL_Fundamental_Analysis_2026-10-19, GEHC_Fundamental_Analysis_Oct2026, NVDA_Post_Earnings_Entry_Point_Assessment_20260828, SPCX_Q3_AI_Buildout_Impact_2026-10-20 (Investments project).
5. **Earnings and macro:** PrimeXBT on Alphabet Q3; 24/7 Wall St. on Amazon, Meta, Alphabet; AI Weekly on Microsoft FQ1; GE Vernova Q3 release; Tradingpedia on GE HealthCare; Pomegra on Caterpillar Q3; InsiderFinance on Lockheed Q3; Admiral Markets on the Oct 28 FOMC; TheStreet market wrap, Oct 30.
6. **Not verified against filings:** earnings figures above come from secondary coverage; SEC exhibits for CAT and GEV could not be retrieved this session.

Prepared Fri. Oct 30, 2026 for the Investments portfolio. Prices are official closes. Bands are decision levels for staged buying, not price targets. Provisional bands are not house-underwritten. Internal research for the portfolio manager; not personalized investment advice.